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Speeches, Free Groceries, Films Highlight Day-Long Activities

BLACK PANTHER PARTY SO. CALIFORNIA CHAPTER RE-OPENS



BPINS photos



ELAINE BROWN (left) and ERICKA HUGGINS (right) were the featured speakers in the ceremonies held on Monday in Los Angeles to highlight the re-opening of the Southern California BPP Chapter, which will be coordinated by longtime activist BOB DUREN (in back, second photo from left).

(Los Angeles, Calif.) — January 17, 1977, marked the re-opening of the Southern California Chapter of the Black Panther Party, with an all-day schedule of events highlighted by speeches from Black Panther Party chairperson Elaine Brown, Oakland Community School Director Ericka Huggins, also a leading Party member, and the distribution of 500 free bags of groceries at the Party's new South Central Avenue headquarters.

Eight years earlier on this very day, January 17, 1969, the Southern California Chapter's founder/coordinator Alprentice "Bunchy" Carter, and John Huggins, one of the Chapter's first members and Ericka's husband, were assassinated on the UCLA campus by cowardly

reactionaries from the Ron Karenga-led US organization, part of the infamous FBI COINTELPRO plot to destroy the then fledgling Black Panther Party.

January 17 was a very special day for many of the participants in the re-opening, a day heavily laden with deep meaning, when the past, present and future of the liberation struggle in America came together; a day when History could occasionally slow down, speed up, stand still, become a vehicle that the heart's memories could ride on the winds of change, of a struggle one ultimately realized could, indeed, be harnessed, but only with the most supreme sacrifices, in the people's

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